

GOKHALE MEMORIAL GIRLS' SCHOOL

PRE BOARD EXAMINATION - II (2025-26)

CLASS - X

ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE

Time - 3 hrs. 15 mins.

Full Marks - 80

General Instructions :

1. The question paper has **THREE sections**:
Reading Skills, Creative Writing Skills & Literature
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part

1. Read the passage carefully and answer the following questions : (10)

1. Roshni Bairwa remembers running all the day from her home in Mahmoodnagar Dhani village to the room where the 'balsamoooh' (children's group) met. "My grandparents are getting me married. "You have to do something", the girl then 12 year old told, the 20 or so children sitting there.
2. The children, all aged between eight and sixteen, trooped up to Roshni's house and urged her grandparents to stop the impending wedding.

Others including village elders and teachers, joined in. The wedding was stopped, she had discovered a way out of the quagmire with the help of a local NGO and the village children.

3. When she was in 12th, the pressure to get married returned. This time her uncle found a match for her. When she resisted, she was taunted and beaten. People would point to her as the girl who brought shame to her family and asked their children not to speak to her. "I was 16 years old and alone in the world. I walked to school with my eyes fixed to the ground. I would think sometimes what have I done that is so terrible for everyone to hate me so much? I would cry myself to sleep", recalls Roshni, who lost her father when she was two and had been abandoned by her mother shortly after. But even in those dark moments, Roshni didn't give up, moving out of the village to Peeplu tehsil in Rajasthan where she rented a room and attended college.

4. With education and independence came a sense of confidence. "I kept in touch with the children in the village. Every time, there was a

child marriage, they would call me and I would go to stop it. I realized, I had already been thrown out of the village, the worst had already happened, what else could the villagers do? So I went and fought with everyone who was getting their child married," she says with a laugh. So far she has stopped over a dozen marriages.

5. Even without the support of the law, young girls have been crusading against the practice. Earlier this month, 19 year old Sushila Bishnoi from Barmer succeeded in getting her marriage annulled, submitting photographs and congratulatory messages from her husband's facebook account to the court. The court accepted these as evidence that the union took place when both the bride and groom were 12 years old and declared the marriage invalid.

6. Seema Bairwal (name changed) was 15 when she was married to a man few years older. Later when she started attending 'Bal Smooh' meeting with NGO Shiv Shakti Samity, and save the children, it dawned on her that she had a choice, "I learnt that my life is mine. I have the power to say no to marriage."

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer ten of the following questions

- a. What does Roshni's act of running to the meeting of the 'bal samooch' indicate? (1)
- i. Desperation ii. Anxiety
 - iii. Fear iv. Happiness
- b. Which statements are NOT TRUE according to the passage? (1)
- 1. Roshni Bairwa's parents were against her marriage
 - 2. Roshni was helped by her neighbours when she was being married off at the age of 12.
 - 3. Sushila Bishnoi's wedding was cancelled by her family
 - 4. Local NGOs have been trying their best to stop child marriages
- i. 2 and 4 ii. 1 and 3
 - iii. 3 and 4 iv. 1 and 2
- c. Why was Roshni beaten up at the age of sixteen? (2)

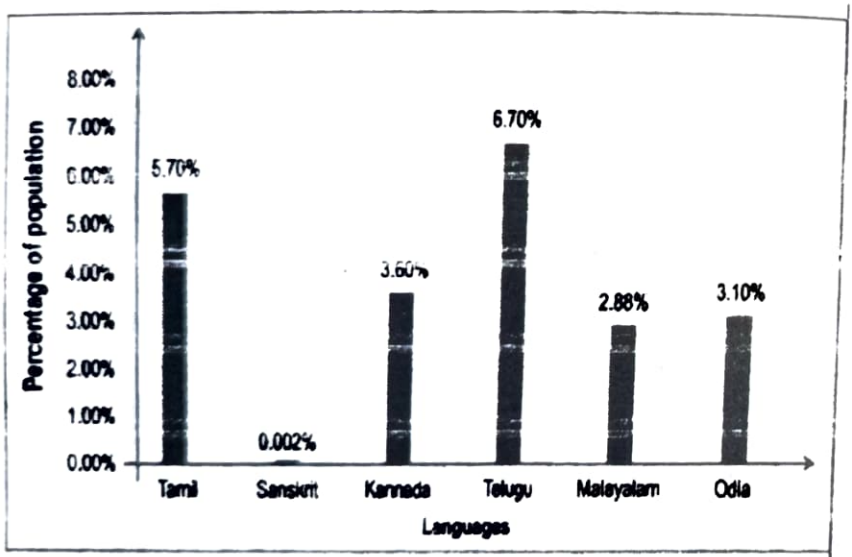
- d. It was _____ that made Roshni confident. (1)
- i. running away from home
 - ii. ☒ education
 - iii. a new job
 - iv. support from NGOs
- e. Roshni moved out of the village in order to attend college (1)
- f. Which of the following means the same as 'annulled' in para 5? (1)
- i. ☒ To state officially that something is not legally valid
 - ii. To help somebody
 - iii. Impending doom
 - iv. Social work
- g. What role did the NGOs play in prevention of child marriages (2)
- h. Give a suitable title to the passage. (1)

2. Read the following passage carefully and answer the following questions- (10)

(1) India is a country of many languages. The constitution recognizes 22 languages officially, but over 121 unique languages have been identified in the country.

(2) To preserve and encourage the literary function of language, the government introduced 'classical language' in 2004. According to the Ministry of the Culture, a classical language is one that is at least 1,500 years old and has ancient, valuable literature recorded in it. Further, such a language is original and not derived from another language. Based on 4 of 13 these guidelines, six languages have been classified as classical languages. Tamil, Sanskrit, Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam and Odia.

(3) The following graph shows the percentage of Indian people whose mother is a classical language. This is as per data collected by the census of 2011. The census was not conducted in 2021 due to the pandemic.



(4) According to the graph, around 6.7% of the Indian population are native speakers of Telugu, whereas Sanskrit has been identified as a mother tongue only by 0.002% of the population, which is around 24,821 people. Malayalam has the second lowest number of native speakers, making up about 2.9% of Indians.

(5) The 2011 census data also noted that a majority of the native speakers reside in the area that their mother tongue originated from. For example, 93% of Kannada speakers live in Karnataka. Similarly, 93% of Malayalam speakers live in Kerala.

(6) Balancing preservation of culture and inclusivity is a delicate equation for a heterogeneous country like India. With growing awareness, concepts like 'classical language' may help us achieve harmony.

- i. Which of these pieces of information can be confirmed by reading the passage? (1)
- I. the number of people who speak Tamil
 - II. where the majority of native Sanskrit speakers live

III. the reason Malayalam is considered a classical language

IV. when the idea of classical languages was introduced in India

A. Only I

B. Only IV

C. Only I and II

D. Only III and IV

- ii. Fill in the blanks with appropriate option from those given in the brackets (1)

Based on the passage, the _____ (functional/historical) value of a language is of utmost importance while (preserving/categorizing) it as a classical language.

- iii. Imagine that a committee was formed to ensure that classical languages have more native speakers by the time the next census is conducted. In 40 words, answer the following questions to help the committee achieve its objective. (2)

1. Which classical language needs its attention most urgently and why?

2. Which classical language would be THIRD on its priority?

- iv. State an example from the passage that shows that India is a heterogeneous country. Answer in one sentence. (1)

- v. Why has the writer stated the following line in the passage? Give a reason. (1)

The census was not conducted in 2021 due to pandemic.

- vi. Complete the sentence based on information from the passage (1)

If Tamil originated from Tamil Nadu, we can infer that majority of the native Tamil speakers would be living in Tamil Nadu.

- vii. Which of these hypothetical situations would help India achieve harmony? Justify your answer **in about 40 words**. (2)

- a. if the majority of Indians who speak a classical language are settled abroad
- b. if more languages from remote and tribal areas of India are identified as classical languages
- c. if the percentage of Indians who are native Telugu speakers increases more than 10%

viii. Which of these statements uses 'delicate' in the same way as paragraph (6) does?

- A. She looked beautiful in the dress with the delicate floral pattern
- B. He was frequently admitted to the hospital due to his delicate health
- C. This discussion will require careful consideration as it is a delicate matter
- D. Please handle these delicate items carefully during transportation as they break easily

SECTION- B

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

3. Do as directed (1x10=10)

- i. Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal letter

Dear Mr. Patel, We are pleased to inform you that your proposal for the upcoming project _____ by the board of directors.

- A. had endorsed
- B. will have been endorsed

~~C.~~ has been endorsed

D. have endorsed

- ii. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence

Thieves held the manager at the hotel on gun point. Use the given format for your response. ERROR CORRECTION.

- iii. Abhilash and Neeraj had a conversation about Abhilasha's swimming practice.

Report Neeraj's question. 'Isn't she afraid of water?'

- ✓ iv. Read the dialogue between Shabnam and her mentor, Sara, regarding her summer internship programme.

Shabnam: Ah! I am convinced this programme has the potential to enhance my abilities

Sara : Why did you choose to participate in this internship programme?

Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue.

Sara asked Shabnam _____ in that internship programme. Shabnam sighed and exclaimed that she was convinced that programme had the potential to enhance her ability.

- A. why to choose to participate
- B. to choose participation
- C. why she had chosen to participate

- v. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the line. (One another, altogether, each other, all other)

In a class room students are to be trained to respect _____.

- vi. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

Bread and butter are good for breakfast. Use the given format for your response.

ERROR CORRECTION

- vii. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

She was releevied to hear from the doctor that the tumor was not malignant.

Use the given format for your response.

ERROR CORRECTION

- viii. Complete the given narrative , by filling the blank with the correct option.

For all his _____ he is a _____

A. tricks, cheat

B. stupidity, fool

☒ C. wealth, miser

D. health, player

- ix. Report the dialogue between a teacher and a student, by completing sentence.

Teacher:- Did everyone understand the new assignment? Students:- Yes, we all got it, thank you!

The teacher asked if everyone had understood the new assignment , to which the students *affirmatively*..... expressing their gratitude.

- x. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option from ~~the~~ brackets.

The speaker did not space out his speech properly but went on _____ on one point. (decrying, devoting, stressing, avoiding)

4. Attempt any one of the two, (A) or (B), in about 50 words (1x5=5)

- A. As Vaibhav, the club-in-charge of your school's Ecology Club, you strongly believe in the importance of starting Eco-Clubs in schools in the rural areas surrounding your city to promote the preservation and conservation of nature. Write a letter to the Education Secretary of your city, **in about 120 words**, highlighting the significance of ecological awareness and suggesting the need to establish Eco-Clubs in these schools.

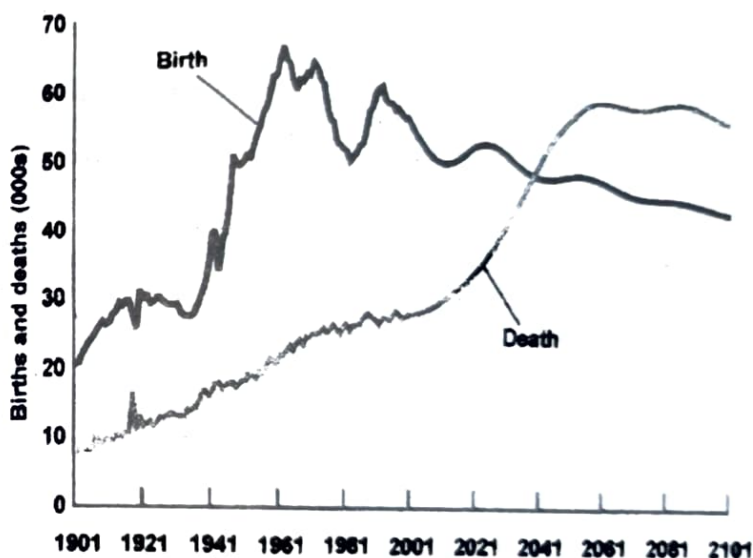
OR

- B. As Amitha, the Vice Head Girl of Vidya Mandir, you are aware of the increasing prevalence of cyber-attacks and unauthorized exploitation of systems, networks, and technologies affecting individuals across all demographics. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily **in about 120 words**, stressing the urgent need to promote digital

security among all age groups. Highlight the challenges posed by cyber threats and propose practical solutions to address this growing issue.

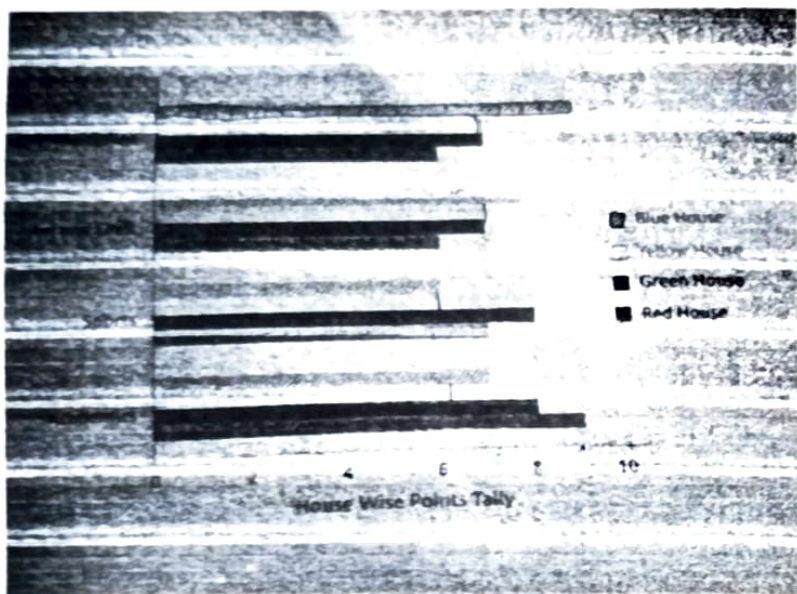
5. Attempt any one of the two, (A) or (B), in 120-150 words (1x5=5)

- A. The given line graph provides information about changes in birth and death rates in New Zealand between 1901 and 2101. Write an analytical paragraph summarizing the information and make comparisons where relevant **in about 100-120 words**.



- B. The following bar graph shows the point tally of four houses of Sacred Heart Convent School for the year 2020-21. The data is to

be used to adjudge the best house of the year and the runners up. Study the data carefully and then write an analytical paragraph summarizing the information **in 100-120 words**. Make comparisons wherever appropriate and draw conclusions.



SECTION -C

LITERATURE TEXTBOOK AND SUPPLEMENTARY READING TEXT (40 MARKS)

6. Read the given extract and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given. (5)

A. Lomov:- "It's cold..... I'm trembling all over, just as if I'd got an examination before me."

The great thing is , I must have my mind made up. If I give myself time to think, to hesitate, to talk a lot, to look for an ideal, or for real love, then i'll never get married. Brr..... It's cold! Natalya Stepanova is an excellent housekeeper, not bad looking, well educated. What more do I want?.....In the first place, I'm already _____ a critical age, so to speak. In the second place, I ought to lead a quiet and regular life. I suffer from palpitations. I'm excitable and always getting awfully upset, at this very moment my lips are trembling , and there's a twitch in my right eyebrow."

- a. Which of the following statements best explains the given sentence? (1)

Lomov is trying to convince himself that Natalya is a suitable match for him.

- i. He is deeply in love with her and cannot stop thinking about her beauty.
- ii. He lists her positive qualities like being a good house keeper, well educated and good looking.

- b. Read the following descriptions and identify which one correctly corresponds to the extract. (1)
- i. A debate is a formal discussion on a particular topic, usually with two or more people presenting different view points and arguments.
 - ii. A soliloquy is a speech given by a character alone on stage, which reveals their innermost thoughts and feelings.
 - iii. An aside is a brief comment or remark made by a character directly to the audience, which is not intended to be heard by other characters on stage.
- c. "In the first place, I'm already _____" (fill in the blank) (1)
- d. How do you assess Lomov's character from the quoted extract? (2)

OR

- B. "It's not my balcony," Ausable said with extreme irritation. "It belongs to the next apartment." He glanced explanatorily at Fowler. "You see," he said, "this room used

to be a part of a large unit, and the next room — through that door there — used to be the living room. It had the balcony, which extends under my window now. You can get onto it from the empty room two doors down — and somebody did, last month. The management promised to block it off. But they haven't." Max glanced at Fowler, who was standing stiffly not far from Ausable, and waved the gun with a commanding gesture."

- a. Fowler was standing stiffly near Ausable — what does that denote? (1)
 - i. Fowler felt amused to see what was going on in the room
 - ii. Fowler was too scared to react
 - iii. Fowler was confused and could not react
- b. "The management promised to block it off. But they haven't." This shows that (1)
 - i. the management was too busy with other work
 - ii. the management was casual and indifferent in approach

iii. the management did not treat all the guests with same importance

c. Select the image that best suits the phrase 'a commanding gesture' (1)



(i)



(ii)

d. Why do you think Ausable takes the effort to describe the balcony at such great length to Fowler? (2)

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given.

(5)

A. 'The fog comes
On little cat feet
It sits looking
Over harbour and city
on silent haunches
and then moves on.'

- a. What does the comparison of a fog to a cat suggest about the nature of fog in the poem? (1)
- i. it is dangerous and violent
 - ii. it arrives suddenly and loudly
 - iii. it arrives silently and stealthily
- b. The cat is sitting on its haunches. Choose the image that aptly describes the scene. (1)



(i)



(ii)



(iii)

- c. The quoted lines give us an example of..... (1)
- i. imagery
 - ii. onomatopoeia
 - iii. simile
- d. What is the tone of the poem in the quoted lines? (2)

OR

B. 'Belinda giggled till she shook the house,
And blink said Weeck ! Which is giggling for
a mouse,
Ink and Mustard rudely asked his age,
When Custard cried for a nice safe cage,
Suddenly, suddenly they heard a nasty sound
And Mustard growled, and they all looked
around.'

- a. What inference can be drawn from the repetition of 'suddenly, suddenly' in the above extract? (1)
- i. The scene shook the house
 - ii. It highlights that the inmates of the house were expecting the noise

- iii. It emphasizes that an unexpected noise was heard
- b. 'When Custard cried for a nice safe cage.' This shows that (1)
 - i. Custard was a peace loving dragon
 - ii. Custard looked for a cage, not a house
 - iii. Both (i) and (ii)
 - iv. The options are not valid
- c. Select the option that applies the same rhyme scheme as the lines of the first four lines of the given extract. (1)
 - i. Through the telescope she saw a star
Which she thought was very far
She stretched her hand
And felt the crumple of the sand.
 - ii. Through the telescope she saw a star
She stretched her hand
As it was very far
But felt the crumple of the sand.

iii. Through the telescope she saw a
star

Which she thought was very far
Her hand she stretched
But felt the crumple of the sand.

iv. Through the telescope she saw a
star

Which she thought was very far
Her hand she stretched afar
But felt the crumple of the sand.

d. Custard proved to be heroic in the end.
Justify. (2)

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following questions in 40-50 words each (3x4=12)

a. Kitty was a trusted friend to Anne. Justify.

b. What stopped Valli from going to the stall to have a drink?

c. ***'Family played a vital role in the first flight of the young seagull.'*** Justify the given statement.

d. In what manner did Lencho's field suffer damage? Did he hold any expectations of receiving assistance?

- e. Nelson Mandela talks about twin obligations.
Comment.

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following questions in 40-50 words each (3x2=6)

- a. Why was it tempting to keep Tricki as a permanent guest at the surgery?
- b. Did Bholi's teacher play any role in transforming her personality?
- c. How would you assess Griffin as a scientist?

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following questions in about 100-120 words (6x1=6)

- a. The natural beauty of Assam and Coorg is panoramic. Even Amanda wants to run into the arms of nature from the suffocating environment of her house. Explain how nature provides joy and solace to people.

OR

- b. Nelson Mandela speaks of achieving self dignity through freedom and liberation of the soul. What, in your opinion, shapes a human being?

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following questions in about 100-120 words

(6x1=6)

- a. **'Everyone must have a chance to reform'**. Anil did give Hari Singh a *second chance* and the latter turned over a new leaf. If you were in Anil's place, how would you have handled the situation?

OR

- b. Rushing to a conclusion without going into details may lead to chaos and failure. Elaborate this with reference to the Martian invasion in the play 'The Book That Saved The Earth.'

**_*_*_